OBAMA FOUNDATION LEADERS

Obama Leaders Application

Se termine sur ven. 4 déc. 2026 19:00

PROGRAM SELECTION

The Obama Foundation currently operates the Obama Leaders program in Africa, Asia-Pacific, Europe, and the United States. Please be aware that, even if you meet the eligibility criteria for multiple Leaders programs, you may only submit an application for one program. If you have questions about which program is right for you, please visit our website to learn more about each specific Obama Leaders program and the eligibility requirements that apply.

This application is comprised of 10 sections and will display in two parts. The application will save as you complete it. Feel free to work through the sections at your own pace.

Part 1

1. Basic Information
2. Geographical Information
3. Your Changemaking Work
4. Essay Questions

Part 2

1. Video Questions
2. Short Biography
3. References
4. Resume
5. Additional + Optional Information
6. Data Privacy and TOCs

Please note that correcting mistakes or making edits after your application has been submitted, including reference requests, is not allowed.

Which Obama Leaders program are you applying for? (requis)

- ◯ Africa
- ◯ Asia-Pacific
- ◯ Europe
- ◯ USA

BASIC INFORMATION

Given Name(s) (requis)

Middle Name(s)

Last Name(s)/Surname(s) (requis)

Preferred Name

Email Address (requis)

email@example.com

Note: We will be using the email associated with your Submittable account to send important communications about the Obama Leaders program. Please be sure you are checking that email regularly and have our notifications safelisted.

Phone Number (requis)

Please enter your birthdate. For ease, please enter the date in the following format: MM/DD/YYYY (requis)

For example, 25 October 1988 would appear as 10/25/1988.

Please select which of these most closely aligns with your leadership moment as you apply for this program, based on the options below. (requis)

- ◯ Starting: I'm taking on leadership for the first time or in a new, unfamiliar context. I'm figuring out my voice, influence, and approach.
- ◯ Building: I'm leading a team or project and learning how to drive results, manage people, and grow trust.
- ◯ Transitioning: I'm reevaluating my leadership: letting go, mentoring others, or reshaping my role to support different areas of change.
- ◯ Sustaining: I'm holding long-term responsibility and focusing on legacy, culture, and system-level influence.
- ◯ Scaling: I have a proven model that I am working to bring to new communities or partners in order to deepen or widen impact.

This question is meant to help us learn more about your background. We welcome applicants in all stages of their leadership journeys.

Do you currently hold an elected position in public office? (requis)

- ◯ Yes
- ◯ No

Have you previously applied for any of the following programs? Please select all that apply, regardless of the outcome of your previous applications. (requis)

- ☐ Leaders Africa
- ☐ Leaders Asia-Pacific
- ☐ Leaders Europe
- ☐ Leaders USA
- ☐ Obama-Chesky Voyager Scholarship for Public Service
- ☐ Obama Foundation Scholars
- ☐ I have never applied to any of the programs listed above.

Note: Prior applications will not affect your eligibility or consideration.

How did you hear about this program? (requis)

- ◯ Obama Foundation email
- ◯ Obama Foundation staff or information session
- ◯ Obama Foundation program alumni
- ◯ Social media
- ◯ Word of mouth (friend, family, colleague, etc.)
- ◯ Other

GEOGRAPHICAL INFORMATION

In which city or town is your primary place of residence located? (requis)

How would you describe the area where you live? (requis)

- ◯ Major city
- ◯ Suburb or area near a major city
- ◯ Small city or large town
- ◯ Small town or village
- ◯ Rural community
- ◯ Remote area (far from towns, services, or major transport)

I would identify as an Obama Leader of _____?

YOUR CHANGEMAKING WORK

The questions below reference the work you do that has the most positive social impact. You do not have to be doing your changemaking work full-time nor as your main professional focus to be eligible for the program.

Current job or position title where you do your changemaking work. (requis)

Current organization or institution where you do your changemaking work. (requis)

What is the mission or purpose of the organization or institution? (requis)

Website of the organization or institution where you do your changemaking work. (If not available, please skip this question.)

example.com

Which response best describes your level of engagement with your changemaking work? (requis)

- ◯ My changemaking work is my full-time job.
- ◯ I divide my time between my changemaking work and other jobs or professional responsibilities that have a different focus.

Which sector best describes your changemaking work? (requis)

- ◯ Public sector
- ◯ Private sector
- ◯ Civil society
- ◯ Not listed
- ◯ Prefer not to say

Which industry best describes your changemaking work? (requis)

Sélectionner...

Please select the issue area that best reflects the focus of your changemaking work. We understand that there is no perfect way to categorize everyone's work. The categories below reflect the most common categories that we have observed and anticipate in our network. (requis)

Sélectionner...

If you would like, please use this space to highlight other issue areas that intersect with your work in addition to the primary issue area you already selected.

B I U

REFERENCES

As part of your application, you are required to provide two references, including their name, email address, and their affiliation with you. Your reference should know you well and be able to speak to your character, leadership qualities, and changemaking work. By providing a reference's information, you represent that you have their permission to provide The Obama Foundation their contact information.

All reference forms must be submitted no later than of December 18 at 12:00 PM United States Central Time (UTC-6), two weeks after the official application deadline, in order for your application to be considered complete. To ensure your references have ample time to complete their forms, we strongly recommend issuing your references before you submit your completed application. Submitting at the last minute may not allow sufficient time for your references to respond.

We cannot provide individual status updates on reference submissions due to the high volume of applications. **Application and Reference request edits will not be permitted, so please review the status in your application and follow up directly with your reference for their submission status.**

⚠️ Please be sure to let your references know to expect the reference request to come from the following email address: notifications@email.submittable.com ⚠️

Feel free to share this related help article with them as well.

Reference 1: Name (requis)

Prénom (requis)

Nom de famille (requis)

Reference 1: Title (requis)

Reference 1: Affiliation (requis)

Reference 1: What is your relationship with this reference? (requis)

Reference 2: Name (requis)

Prénom (requis)

Nom de famille (requis)

Reference 2: Title (requis)

Reference 2: Affiliation (requis)

Reference 2: What is your relationship with this reference? (requis)

Essay Questions

The application form will not accept responses outside of the specified word range. We encourage you to write your responses in a separate document first to check the word count and in case you encounter any technical issues while completing your application. While AI may be used as a supplemental resource, please use it strategically to support, rather than drive your application submission. Our goal is to evaluate your unique thinking and background.

In two sentences, describe the specific challenge you are working to address and the approach you are taking to create change. (requis)

Limite: 50 mots

Example: Too many leaders take on challenges in isolation, without the peer community, resources, and cross-sector relationships that sustain hard work. Through my work, I connect leaders worldwide with experts, coaches, and a values-driven network to deepen their impact at home and spread what works.

What meaningful change has occurred because of your changemaking work, and how do you know? Please include evidence, data, feedback, or other indicators that show that this change occurred. (requis)

Limite: 250 mots

Why is now the right time for you to participate in this program? Describe a leadership challenge you're currently facing and share a specific example from the past six months of how it has affected your work or your team. How has this experience shaped what you're hoping to gain from the program? (requis)

Limite: 250 mots

Tell us about a time when achieving the best outcome required you to put the collective ahead of your own role, recognition, or preferred approach. What did you do, what changed, and what did you learn as a result? (requis)

Limite: 250 mots

As part of our commitment to building a cohort of leaders with varied experiences, approaches, backgrounds, and points of view, we want to understand what makes each applicant unique. What would be missing from our cohort if you were not included? (requis)

Limite: 250 mots

Are you ready to continue to Part 2? (requis)

- [ ] Yes

Enregistrer le brouillon | Continuer

Les brouillons peuvent être visibles par les administrateurs de ce programme.